Digital Literacy

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NAME OF STUDENT: SAHANA SAXENA
REGISTRATION NUMBER: 25BCE10393

Introduction

In today's fast-paced digital era, technology has become integral to education, communication, collaboration, and professional growth. Digital literacy extends beyond basic device usage—it encompasses the ability to navigate online tools effectively, communicate responsibly, protect personal data, and build a credible digital footprint.

As a Student Digital Ambassador, this project provided a structured opportunity to develop these essential 21st-century skills through practical, hands-on tasks. The initiative focused on five key areas: creating an informative infographic on digital literacy, building a professional digital portfolio across multiple platforms, exploring coding and collaboration tools, practicing formal email etiquette, and raising awareness about cybercrimes, particularly phishing attacks.

Through these activities, I not only gained technical proficiency but also developed critical thinking, creativity, and a deeper understanding of online safety and professional presence. These skills are vital for succeeding in academic projects, internships, and future careers in a technology-driven world. This report documents my learning journey, reflections, and key takeaways from each task.

Task 1: Digital Literacy Infographic

For Task 1, I designed a comprehensive Digital Literacy Infographic using Canva, a user-friendly graphic design platform. The infographic aimed to educate fellow students on the core components of digital literacy, including safe internet practices, responsible social media usage, and strategies for building a professional online presence.

I selected a clean, modern template with a balanced color scheme (blues and greens for trust and clarity) and incorporated relevant icons, bullet points, and short explanatory texts. Key sections covered:

Defining digital literacy
Importance of strong, unique passwords and two-factor authentication
Avoiding phishing links and suspicious downloads
Tips for creating professional profiles on LinkedIn and GitHub

Designing the infographic challenged me to simplify complex ideas into visually appealing content. Initially, balancing text density with visuals was difficult, but iterating on layouts and using Canva's alignment tools helped me create an engaging final design. This task significantly improved my visual communication and design skills. It also reinforced how infographics can make important digital safety information more accessible and memorable for students.

Task 2: Digital Portfolio

In Task 2, I established a strong foundation for my professional digital presence by creating and optimizing profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

On GitHub, I updated my profile with a professional profile picture, a clear bio highlighting my academic background and interest in technology, and pinned repositories (or created a special username repository for a dynamic README if possible). This platform serves as a showcase for coding projects and version control skills.

On LinkedIn, I added my education details, including my current degree and university, along with a professional summary. I also began connecting with alumni and industry professionals to expand my network.

On Kaggle, I set up a profile focused on data science exploration, where I can participate in competitions, analyze public datasets, and build notebooks in Python.

This exercise helped me understand the long-term value of maintaining consistent, professional profiles across platforms. In the coming four years of my degree, I plan to regularly update these profiles by uploading academic projects, contributing to open-source repositories, participating in Kaggle discussions, and documenting my learning journey. Building this portfolio early gives me a competitive edge for internships and placements.

Task 3: Coding & Collaboration Platforms

Task 3 involved hands-on exploration of coding and collaboration tools. I created an account on HackerRank and successfully completed the beginner-friendly challenge “Solve Me First”. This problem required reading two integers from input, computing their sum, and outputting the result—helping me practice basic syntax, input/output handling, and simple problem-solving logic in a structured environment.

HackerRank’s interface and instant feedback system made it an excellent platform for building logical thinking and programming confidence.

Additionally, I created a “Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz” using Google Forms. The quiz included five questions in multiple-choice and short-answer formats to test knowledge of safe online practices. I customized the form with a clear title, instructions, and theme. Responses were automatically collected in Google Sheets, allowing easy analysis and visualization of results.

These tools demonstrated the power of digital platforms for both individual skill-building and collaborative learning. Coding platforms like HackerRank sharpen technical abilities, while Google Workspace tools enhance organization and data collection—skills I will continue applying in group projects and academic work.

Task 4: Email Etiquette

Task 4 emphasized professional communication. I drafted two formal emails:

A polite request for an assignment extension, including a clear subject line, context, reason, and proposed new deadline.
An application for a summer internship, highlighting my relevant skills and enthusiasm.

Both emails followed best practices: professional greeting ("Dear Sir/Madam" or specific name), concise and structured body, courteous tone, and appropriate closing ("Best regards" followed by full name and contact details).
I also prepared a Social Media Do's and Don'ts Checklist, covering points such as:

Maintaining a professional profile picture and bio
Avoiding sharing unverified or offensive content
Thinking before posting and using privacy settings wisely

This task highlighted how poor email etiquette (e.g., missing subject lines or casual language) can harm first impressions, while strong practices build credibility in academic and professional settings.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness

In Task 5, I focused on phishing attacks, one of the most prevalent forms of cybercrime. Phishing involves deceptive emails, messages, or fake websites designed to trick users into revealing sensitive information like passwords, bank details, or personal data.

I studied how attackers often impersonate trusted organizations (banks, universities, or government portals) and create urgency to prompt quick action. Common consequences include financial loss, identity theft, and data breaches. Students are frequent targets due to their active online presence and sometimes lower awareness.

I created a Phishing Prevention Checklist with practical tips:

Never click links or download attachments from unknown sources
Verify URLs by hovering over them or typing the official address manually
Enable two-factor authentication wherever possible
Report suspicious messages to the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal

What surprised me most was how sophisticated and realistic many phishing attempts appear today. This task has made me more vigilant—I now habitually verify links and sources before interacting with them.

Conclusion

This Student Digital Ambassador project has been an enriching and practical learning experience. It equipped me with essential digital skills ranging from visual design and portfolio building to coding practice, professional communication, and cyber safety awareness.

I now feel significantly more confident in using digital tools responsibly, presenting information effectively, and protecting myself online. The hands-on nature of each task bridged the gap between theoretical knowledge and real-world application.

Moving forward, I am committed to updating my digital profiles regularly, practicing coding consistently, and applying the safety habits I learned. These competencies will undoubtedly support my academic success and prepare me for a competitive professional environment. Overall, the project has helped shape me into a more responsible, skilled, and aware digital citizen.

References

Canva
Google Forms & Google Workspace
HackerRank
GitHub
LinkedIn
Kaggle
National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal, Government of India

END OF REPORT